



THIS IS TECHNOLOGY, CULTURE AND SCIENCE WITH A DIFFERENCE, AND THAT DIFFERENCE IS USUALLY ENOUGH TO MAKE MOST NORMAL PEOPLE GO "WTF?"

WHAT WERE THEY THINKING?

USE YOUR BRAIN:

One can't help but notice that quite a few things in America are different by design - units, driving side and more. Find out why in Geek-key. While brain computer interfaces might be far from reality, we imagined a future where they are very much a part of everyday life, in Future Feature. All of that with your regular dose of DGT goodness - that's ALT for this month.



Psychopaths can be very adaptive

Psychopaths are often thought of as being highly maladaptive and are often associated to having a lack of empathy and emotions. However, new research in the scientific journal Personality and Individual Differences has found otherwise.

<http://dgit.in/psychowhat>

WHAT'S NEW

Google's A.I creates better code than its creators

Google's automated machine learning system, the mysterious AutoML, develops neural networks of its own. The company recently announced that the AutoML has successfully duplicated and improved itself, with more efficient code.

The project was started in May as an AI that would help Google create other AI systems. It was a matter of time, but AutoML has successfully improved on its own code - what it



was created for. Essentially, AutoML is now 'smarter' than the team of 1300 people who were tasked with creating it.

AutoML has made several headlines and broken several records so far. It broke the record for categorising images

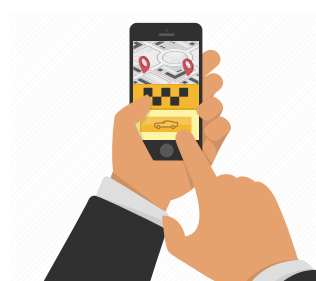
by content and also beat a human-built system for marking the location of multiple objects in an image field. According to Google, these processes can integrate into furthering AR and VR.

<http://dgit.in/googleautoml>

Apple gave Uber unprecedented access

It was recently found out that the Uber app has a secret backdoor to Apple's devices, allowing the service to access and record a user's screen and other personal information without their knowledge.

The ability is not disclosed anywhere on any information that's displayed to the app's consumers. This despite the fact that the company is giving Uber access to features which are off-limits



to outside companies.

There's no info or knowledge as to whether Uber has made use of the special

features/privileges. But now that it has been revealed that they actually have access to these features raises even more questions about the company's controversial business practices.

According to Uber, the code was not being used and was a "vestige from an earlier version of its Apple Watch app" which set off alarm bells among experts.

<http://dgit.in/uberbackd>



Alexa fooled by a parrot

A pet parrot from London was able to make an order online, mimicking its owner after overhearing a conversation. How it went from triggering the keyword 'Alexa' to actually placing and confirming the order is not yet known.

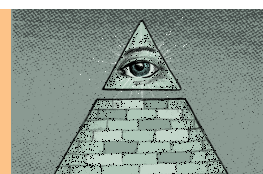
<http://dgit.in/parotorder>



Wireless sex toy gets hacked

A serious security flaw was discovered with a Bluetooth-enabled sex toy which allowed hackers to remotely take control of the toy using their laptop. The reason is apparently a cheap and insecure version of Bluetooth which has no built-in protocol security.

<http://dgit.in/stoyhax>



Conspiracy theorists have a problem

According to a paper published in the European Journal of Social Psychology some people sense danger even when there's no signs of the same, driving them to believe in conspiracy theories. It's called illusory pattern perception.

<http://dgit.in/conspcog>